



IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 02- Communication Process and Roadblocks

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Communication as a Process

- Human communication process is an essential systematic method and means to transfer information as well as emotions.
- Past surveys indicate that an individual spends 75% of their time in some form of communication activity, i.e. **L**istening, **S**peaking, **R**eading, and **W**riting.

Raymond Ross emphasizes the need to bring awareness of the speech communication of mankind through which, “Our behaviour will increasingly reflect **openness**, **tolerance** for ambiguity, **concern** for context, **caution** with language, and greater **respect** for feedback, mutual **influence** and our **dependence** upon one another.

Communication is a Social Function

- ❖ Humans as a social being depend on communicative acts to carry out their personal and public life in a better manner.
- ❖ Communication provides a channel for *two-way influence* between individuals or groups.
- ❖ An effective communication comprises a well-defined cause with an intended effect.
- ❑ Functions of Communication:
 - To inform
 - To persuade
 - To motivate

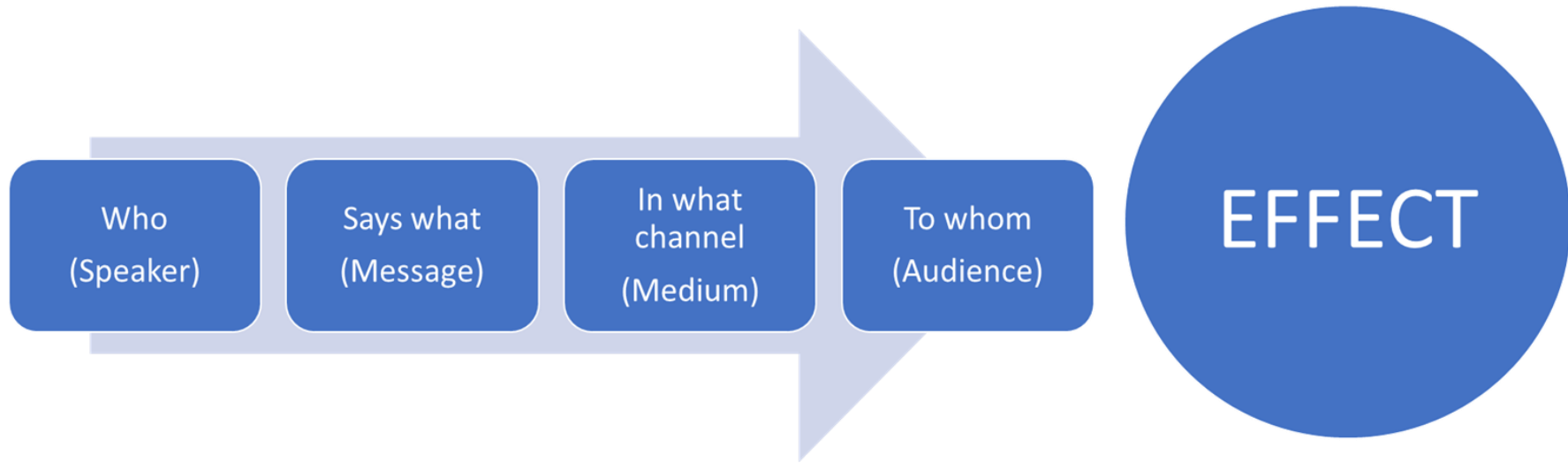
Purposes of Speech Communication

- The three main functions of communication posits itself as the purpose to attain certain intended goals of a speaker through his speech communication.
- The three general purposes of a public speech shall be correlated to specific goals to be achieved:

01	To inform	• Clarity • Interest • Understanding
02	To persuade	• Belief • Action • Stimulation
03	To entertain	• Interest • Enjoyment • Humor

Lasswell's Model of Communication

WHO
SAYS WHAT
IN WHAT CHANNEL
TO WHOM
WITH WHAT EFFECT



Types of Communication

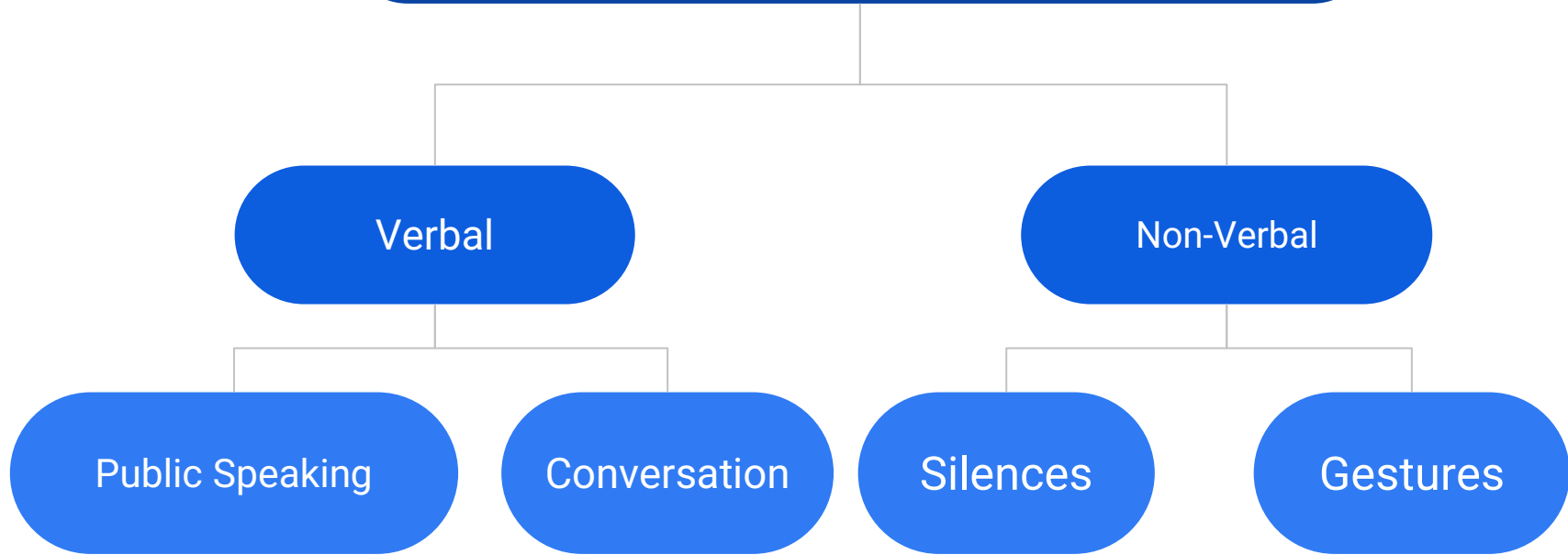
Verbal Communication

- ❖ In Verbal Communication, words are used to convey any message.
- ❖ It is of two types: Written and Oral Communication
- ❖ Examples of Written Communication: Letters, Texting, E-mails, Books
- ❖ Examples of Oral Communication: Face-to-face conversations, Speech, Host on Radio, Interview, Group Discussion etc.

Non-Verbal Communication

- ❖ In Non-Verbal Communication, body language is employed to convey any message.
- ❖ Examples of Non-Verbal Communication:
Waving, Smile, Head Nod, Handshakes, Hugs, Sign Language

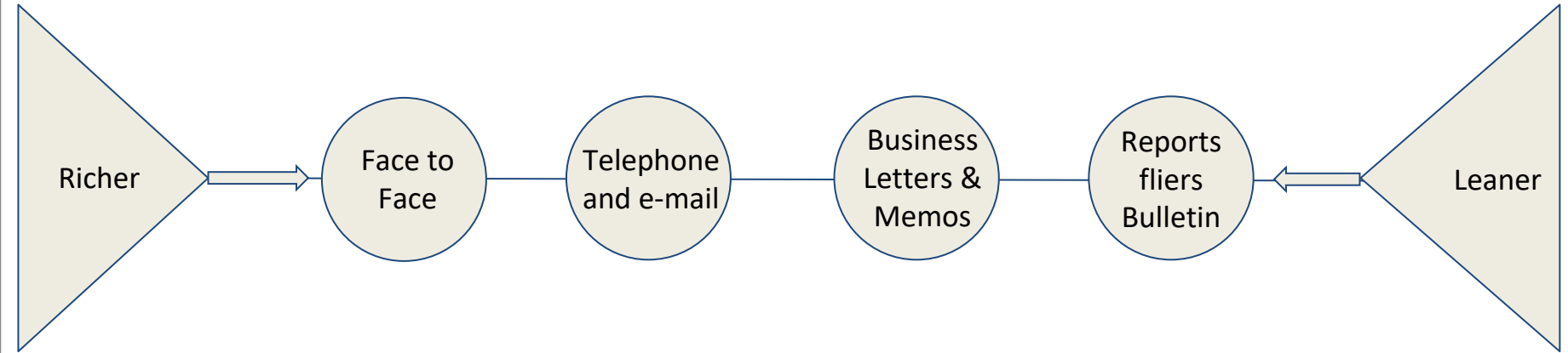
Classification of Communication



Choice/Medium of Communication

- Choice of right medium of communication is essential
- Wrong medium doesn't allow the intended meaning to reach to the targeted audience
- Value of the medium in the given communication situation is called **media richness** (Bovee 168).
- Its determinants are:
 - The ability to convey a message with the help of multiple informational cue.
 - The ability to get feedback and develop personal focus.

Media Richness Continuum



Public Speaking as a Communicative Act

Public Speaking is a vital skill for multiple reasons. Some of the reasons are as follows:

➤ **To win over a crowd**

- Public Speaking is an essential skill both inside and outside the workplace. Speaking with poise and confidence can win over numerous clients and even oppositions.
- Language should be fluid, intriguing and should evoke curiosity.
- Making forward strides is equally essential in order to make a strong case.

➤ To motivate people

- Public Speaking is vested with the power of motivation where one can influence someone to stop doing something, change a behaviour, and to obtain goals.
- It should be exciting enough for peers, customers, employees, coworkers.

➤ To inform

- Being informative is a vital component of Public Speaking.
- Be it demonstrating or convincing, facts are essential to support any form of persuasion

Roadblocks in Communication

- ❑ There are different types of communication barriers which dilute the effectiveness of communication and even jeopardize the whole cause.

1. Language barrier

- a. Use of casual language. (Informal)
- b. Excessive use of jargon (Too formal)
- c. Lack of clarity in words chosen. (Ambiguity)

2. Psychological barrier

- a. Argumentative mindset.
- b. Narrow mindedness.
- c. Lack of emotional awareness.

Contd...

3. Cultural barriers:

- a. Lacking cultural sensitivity towards the audience.
- b. Carrying cultural stereotypes.
- c. Name-calling and Abusive language.

4. Physical barriers:

- a. Noisy environment/ audience.
- b. Poor architecture of seminar/ lecture halls.
- c. Faulty channel. Technical issues.

Contd...

5. Attitudinal barriers:

- a. Personality conflicts.
- b. Lack of self-confidence.
- c. Motivational deficiency.

6. Interpersonal barriers:

- a. Fear for criticism
- b. Defensive speech communication.
- c. Lack of mutual-confidence.



Remedies to Communication Roadblocks

- Adopt an audience-centered approach
- Encourage candid communication climate
- Reduce the number of levels
- Facilitate feedback
- Commit to ethical communication
- Compose efficient messages
- Be generous and patient
- Avoid making false assumptions

“The single biggest problem in communication is the illusion that it has taken place.”

- George Bernard Shaw

Thank You

Works Consulted

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